

Michael Allen

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Bilingual English/Spanish, TS/SCI-cleared technical support professional with hands-on experience in Linux, Kubernetes (K3s), networking, GitOps, and observability. Proven record supporting external customers across multiple time zones, gathering technical requirements, documenting reproducible issues, delivering technical training, and translating complex problems for engineers and senior stakeholders. Rapidly adapts to unfamiliar environments and troubleshoots Linux, Kubernetes, networking, and application failures using logs, CLI tools, and telemetry in mission-critical, high-compliance environments.

CUSTOMER SUPPORT & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages, Clearance & Certification:** Bilingual English/Spanish; Active TS/SCI (CI Polygraph); CompTIA Security+
- **Customer & Technical Support:** Requirements gathering, external customer coordination, technical documentation, reproduction steps, technical training, executive communication
- **Systems & Troubleshooting:** RHEL, Debian, NixOS, systemd, journalctl, process debugging, networking (DNS, Firewall, reverse proxies)
- **Cloud-Native & Containers:** Kubernetes (K3s), Podman, Docker, Helm, Kustomize, GitOps, FluxCD, SOPS
- **Infrastructure & Observability:** Terraform, Git/GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Grafana, Longhorn, Backblaze B2, Python, Bash

CUSTOMER & TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Support & Web Consultant (Volunteer) (Mar 2026 - Present)

Melodee Designs / Decatur, AL

- Support the company's production website and business IT environment, maintaining Hugo/Blowfish, custom CSS, Git-based Cloudflare Pages deployments, and production DNS routing.
- Configured Google Workspace and Cloudflare DNS, including business email routing and SPF/DKIM/DMARC authentication; recommended Google Workspace and Buffer based on operational needs and cost.
- Integrating Decap CMS to enable owner-managed website updates and designing a self-hosted Baserow catalog for internal and customer-facing costume inventory.

Operations Support Lead (Oct 2025 - Present)

U.S. Air Force / Department of Defense / National Security Agency

- Serve as a primary point of contact for four division leaders across a 300+ person organization, resolving documentation, readiness, and inter-service coordination issues under time-sensitive operational requirements.
- Developed automated tracking for inbound/outbound personnel logistics, mitigating human error and reducing weekly administrative maintenance overhead by 20%.
- Maintain 100% data integrity and records accountability across four divisions to support real-time emergency response readiness.

Team Lead and Trainer (Jun 2023 - Oct 2025)

U.S. Air Force / Department of Defense / National Security Agency

- Managed direct support and coordination for three external customers across multiple time zones, gathering detailed requirements, fulfilling critical intelligence gaps, and coordinating follow-ups through secure communication channels.
- Authored executive incident summaries and detailed technical reproduction steps to bridge communication between tactical analysts and external agency engineers.
- Led a 15-person operational team and delivered 200+ hours of hands-on technical training, accelerating qualification timelines for 14 analysts by an average of 45 days.

Intelligence Analyst (Jan 2021 - Jun 2023)

U.S. Air Force / Department of Defense / National Security Agency

- Conducted technical analysis across six global communications networks, identifying key protocol behaviors and operational requirements.
- Published and delivered specialized intelligence reports to more than 20 external customer organizations, satisfying six core strategic Information Needs under tight deadlines.
- Delivered dozens of decision-focused briefings to senior military leaders from O-4 through O-7, translating complex technical intelligence into operational implications, risks, and recommended actions.

SELECTED TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Newelle Package Maintainer - Nixpkgs (Aug 2026 - Present)

[Open Source Contributions](#)

- Own ongoing maintenance of the Newelle package in Nixpkgs, coordinating package updates, resolving bug fixes, and maintaining compatibility within a distributed open-source ecosystem.
- Diagnosed a package defect and resolved a user-reported bug by adding missing dependencies, restoring the embedded web browser and MCP functionality.
- Contributed upstream to Newelle by improving documentation, recommending removal of an outdated Nix flake, and updating the Nix installation method to match modern nixpkgs workflow.

Cloud-Native Lab (Jan 2022 - Present)

[Independent Project](#)

- Diagnose Kubernetes, Linux, networking, and application failures using journalctl, ss, kubectl, application logs, and Prometheus/Grafana telemetry, developing repeatable troubleshooting workflows for common failure modes.
- Designed and operate a three-node high-availability K3s cluster hosting 20+ containerized workloads, with deployments managed declaratively through FluxCD, Helm/Kustomize, SOPS, and Git.
- Implemented persistent storage with Longhorn, internal ingress with Traefik, identity-based remote access through Tailscale, S3-compatible backups with Terraform, and monthly disaster recovery exercises.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Defense Language Institute: B.A. in Linguistics (Spanish Emphasis), 2025

Mississippi College: Coursework toward B.S. in Biology (Pre-Med track), 2020

CompTIA: CompTIA Security+, 2026